LESSON PLAN · SCRATCH (GR 3–5) INTERMEDIATE: STORY, QUIZ & MUSIC STUDIO

Lesson 5: Ask and Answer: Stories That Listen

Module 2 | 45 minutes | Input and branching | Grades 3–5 · ages 8–10

Objective: Use “ask and wait” and the answer reporter to personalise a story and let the reader choose what happens next.

Success criteria

- I can ask a question and use the answer.
- I can join text and the answer into a sentence.
- I can make a story branch with if-else.

Key vocabulary

- **input**: Information the user gives the program.
- **answer**: The reporter that stores what was typed.
- **join**: Puts two pieces of text together.
- **branch**: A point where the story can go different ways.

You will need

- Projector with Kitabash (lesson video, Code Lab)
- Devices: 1 per learner or pair
- Printed worksheet (optional)

Timed lesson plan (45 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up (unplugged)**	Choose-your-path walk (5 min): read a two-sentence story aloud and pause for the class to vote “left” or “right”; read the matching ending.
5 min	**Watch**	Play the lesson video with captions; pause at each heading and ask a question.
8 min	**Build along**	A story that knows your name: learners follow the steps.
14 min	**Perform**	Code Lab: hello, you!, Read the code
9 min	**Probe**	Code Lab: choose your path, Stay safe, activity
4 min	**Wrap-up**	Exit ticket: Write the condition that checks if the answer is “yes”.

Unplugged warm-up

Choose-your-path walk (5 min): read a two-sentence story aloud and pause for the class to vote “left” or “right”; read the matching ending.

Teaching the idea

“ask and wait” collects input from the user, stored in the answer reporter. The answer can be joined into speech or tested with if-else to branch the story. Comparison with = is not case-sensitive in Scratch. Model safe questions only.

Analogy: A choose-your-own-adventure book: the reader’s choice decides which page comes next.

Live demo: Live-build the name greeting. Then show the branching story and deliberately type “LEFT” to show case-insensitivity, and “up” to show the else branch.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
Where is the reader’s answer stored?	In the answer reporter.
What happens if they type something unexpected?	The else branch runs.
Which questions should we never ask?	Anything private: address, phone, school, passwords.

Differentiation

Support
Provide the join block pre-filled; learners add only ask and say.

Stretch
A three-way choice using two nested if-else blocks, or a story that remembers two answers in variables.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
The answer reporter shows the question	It holds what the user typed, not the question.
join adds a space automatically	Add the space yourself: “Hello, ”.
Comparisons are case-sensitive	Scratch ignores capitals in =.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write the condition that checks if the answer is “yes”.

Homework
Write a choose-your-path story on paper with one question and two endings.

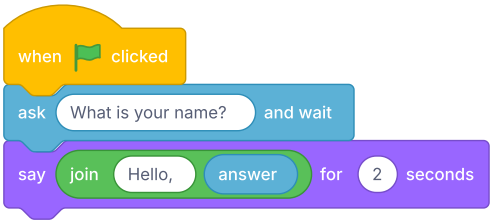
Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Code Lab: hello, you! (perform · code lab)

Goals checked: Asks a question · Says the reader's name

One solution:

Cat



2. Read the code (perform · multiple choice)

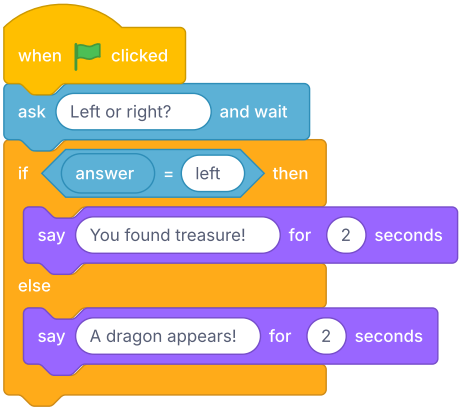
Answer: Hi Ravi

3. Code Lab: choose your path (probe · code lab)

Goals checked: "left" finds treasure · "right" meets a dragon · Uses if-else with the answer

One solution:

Cat



4. Stay safe (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Which planet would you visit?

5. Explain your thinking (probe · free response)

Look for: ask, if, answer. **Example:** I will ask "Do you open the red door or the blue door?". If the answer is red, the cat finds a room full of cake. Else, the cat falls into a pool of jelly.

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** input = Information the user gives the program. · answer = The reporter that stores what was typed. · join = Puts two pieces of text together. · branch = A point where the story can go different ways.
2. **Plan your code:** Goals: Asks a question; Says the reader’s name.
3. **Read the code:** A — The answer reporter holds what was typed: Ravi.
4. **Plan your code:** Goals: “left” finds treasure; “right” meets a dragon; Uses if-else with the answer.
5. **Stay safe:** A. Which planet would you visit? — Never ask for private information. Choices and first names are fine.

Kitabash original curriculum. Scratch is a project of the Scratch Foundation in collaboration with the MIT Media Lab; this course is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.